

THEY NEED YOUR SILENCE UNTIL SEPT 18

Ottawa is deciding whether to **fast-track a 1,000,000 barrel-per-day oil pipeline** down the corridor that runs through this valley; using a law that lets Cabinet shorten the federal review. They've given us slightly over a month to make our voices heard.

DEADLINE **Sept 18**

Written comments accepted until **September 18, 2026**. Cabinet intends to publish notice by **October 1** if it proceeds with the designation. **After that, the decision is made.**

WHAT IS BEING DECIDED

On **August 1, 2026**, a notice in the *Canada Gazette* announced that Cabinet may add the **West Coast Oil Pipeline** to Schedule 1 of the **Building Canada Act**.

Listing a project as being "in the national interest" lets the government **streamline federal approval processes**, moving it into an expedited review under the *Impact Assessment Act* and *Canada Energy Regulator Act*.

The notice went out on the **BC Day long weekend**, while the Interior was under air quality warnings and communities were under evacuation order.

THE CORRIDOR IS HERE

PROPONENT	Government of Alberta
ROUTE	Bruderheim AB → port near Delta BC
LENGTH	~1,250 km · 11 pump stations
CAPACITY	1,000,000 bbl / day
CORRIDOR	"will largely follow the existing Trans Mountain corridor"
FINAL ROUTE	NOT YET DETERMINED
BUILDER	Trans Mountain Corp. (federal Crown)

The existing Trans Mountain corridor runs **directly through Kamloops**. The route is not finalized, which is exactly why input now can still land somewhere.

CABINET HYPOCRISY

The *Gazette* notice lists what Cabinet may weigh. The fifth criterion is printed in the government's own notice:

(e) contribute to clean growth and to meeting Canada's objectives with respect to climate change.

This project is a flagrant violation of this criterion.

WHAT IS ALREADY BURNING

6.28M

HECTARES · BC'S FOUR WORST FIRE SEASONS

2017

– 1.22M ha.

2018

– 1.35M ha.

2021

– Lytton sets Canada's all-time heat record at 49.6 °C, then burns down the next day.

2023

– 2.84M ha. More than double any previous year in recorded history.

All four have happened since 2017. Together they cost more than **\$3 billion in suppression alone**, before counting a single home, evacuation, hospital admission, or lost productivity.

A CLEAR TREND

2023 burned roughly **ten times BC's twenty-year average**. The four most impactful seasons in the province's recorded history have all landed inside the last eight years.

Fire behaviour tracks heat and drought. Heat and drought track cumulative atmospheric carbon.

The same federal government now weighing **forty-plus years of new export capacity** is the one writing the suppression cheques and the disaster relief. **Those are not two separate issues**.

Investing more in fossile fuels means committing to more future disaster management.

THEY BUILT ONE ALREADY

The same Crown corporation that would build this pipeline just finished building the last one. How did that turn out?

2017 · ESTIMATE AT APPLICATION

\$7.4B

2018 · OTTAWA BUYS THE PROJECT

\$4.5B

2020 · REVISED

\$12.6B

2022 · REVISED

\$21.4B

2024 · FINAL, AS BUILT

\$34.2B

THE NEW ONE · ESTIMATE BEFORE A ROUTE EXISTS

\$35–44B

TMX finished at 4.6× its original estimate. The new estimate is already higher than TMX's final cost. Before a route has even been planned.

IT'S NOT WORTH THE COST

The **Parliamentary Budget Officer** valued the finished Trans Mountain system in 2024 at **\$29.6B–\$33.4B**, depending on whether shipper contracts renew after twenty years.

It cost **\$34.2B** to build.

The PBO found that at either valuation, after the bills are paid, what remains would fall short by billions. **A net loss.** The PBO also flagged regulator scenarios showing **considerable spare capacity on the line by the early 2040s.**

Ottawa has been trying to sell it since it opened. **They cannot find a buyer.**

THE CARBON, COUNTED

1,000,000 bbl/day × 365
= 365,000,000 bbl/year
× 0.43 t CO₂ per bbl burned

157 Mt

CO₂ PER YEAR, ONCE BURNED

Canada's **entire national inventory** is roughly 690–700 Mt/year. British Columbia's is roughly 65 Mt.

This single pipeline moves the equivalent of **about 22% of Canada's total emissions**, and **roughly 2.4× everything BC emits.**

Factor: US EPA greenhouse gas equivalency, crude oil consumption.

NATURE HAS NO BORDERS

Those 157 Mt are **downstream** emissions, counted in the buyer's national inventory, not Canada's. **But the atmosphere does not use national accounting boundaries.** Oil loaded at Delta and burned in Asia warms the Thompson Valley exactly as much as oil burned at home. And the Pathways carbon capture project this pipeline is tied to addresses *production* emissions in the oil sands. It does not touch this 157Mt.

SUBMIT WRITTEN COMMENTS TO THE MAJOR PROJECTS OFFICE BEFORE SEPTEMBER 18
WCOPComment-Commentaire0C0@mpo-bgp.gc.ca

- 1 Write your own comment.**
Add *your* voice to the chorus. Say who you are, where you live, your connection to this corridor, your specific concern, and what you want the government to do.
- 2 Copy your MP and MLA, contacts below.**
- 3 Ask Council and the TNRD to file a submission.**
A municipal government's comment on the record outweighs dozens of individual emails. Delegations are open to residents. Ask for a formal resolution before Sept 18.
- 4 Upcomming elections.**
Municipal elections are six weeks after the comment period closes. Now is the time to pressure our local leaders to take a public stance.

WHO TO WRITE · NORTH THOMPSON & KAMLOOPS

PROVINCIAL · KAMLOOPS–NORTH THOMPSON Ward Stamer, MLA <i>Conservative</i> Ward.Stamer.MLA@leg.bc.ca 250-554-5416 · 6188 Tranquille Rd, Kamloops V2B 3H6	PROVINCIAL · KAMLOOPS CENTRE Peter Milobar, MLA <i>Conservative · Shadow Minister for Finance</i> Peter.Milobar.MLA@leg.bc.ca FEDERAL Hon. Dominic LeBlanc <i>Minister responsible for One Canadian Economy</i> dominic.leblanc@parl.gc.ca	PROVINCIAL Hon. David Eby <i>Premier of British Columbia</i> premier@gov.bc.ca BC negotiated coastal spill safeguards. Ask what it negotiated for the interior corridor – the 1,250 km that crosses this valley. MUNICIPAL City of Kamloops · TNRD <i>Mayor and Council · Regional District board</i> kamloops.ca/contact · tnrd.ca Ask for a formal resolution and a written submission before Sept 18.
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